

Word family: **talk / talks / talked / talking / talker / talkative / talkatively / talkativeness**

Base word: talk

Past tense / past participle: talked

** -ing form:** talking

Plural noun: talks

Related forms:

* **talker** (n.) — 說話的人；健談的人

* **talkative** (adj.) — 健談的；多話的

* **talkatively** (adv.) — 健談地；多話地

* **talkativeness** (n.) — 健談；多話

Useful extensions:

* **small talk**

* **talking point**

* **talk show**

* **talk radio**

* **talking shop**

* **pep talk**

* **sales talk**

* **straight talk**

* **double-talk**

* **talking-to** (informal noun)*

Part of speech: mainly **verb** and **noun**

Meaning in this passage

> Sometimes **talking** to him is like trying to keep up with a tiny scientist, because his mind moves at lightning speed.

Here, **talking to him** means **having a conversation with him / communicating with him by speaking**.

talk to someone — 跟某人談話；與某人交談

中文翻譯：

有時候，**跟他聊天 / 交談**就像要努力跟上一位小小科學家的思路一樣，因為他的腦袋轉得飛快。

Here, **“talking to him”** does **“not”** mean giving him a formal speech or merely producing words. It describes **“two-way spoken interaction with Leo”**.

1. **“talk to/with someone (交談) — 跟某人談話；與某人交談”**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Sometimes **“talking to him”** is like trying to keep up with a tiny scientist.

有時候，**“跟他交談”**就像要努力跟上一位小小科學家的思路一樣。

Practice 2

> I really enjoy **“talking to my grandmother”** because she always listens carefully.

我很喜歡**“跟外婆聊天”**，因為她總是很用心聽我說話。

Practice 3

> She spent half an hour **“talking with her neighbour”** outside the building.

她在大廈外面**“跟鄰居聊了半個小時”**。

“MCQ-ready definition:”

“talk to/with someone = 與某人用說話方式交談、溝通”

2. **“talk about something — 談論；談及某件事”**

Here, the focus is the **“subject or topic”** being discussed.

Practice 1

> We spent most of dinner **“talking about our holiday plans”**.

吃晚飯時，我們大部分時間都在**“談論假期計劃”**。

Practice 2

> He loves **“talking about science and space”**.

他很喜歡**談論科學和太空**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk about something = 以某件事為話題進行談論****

3. ****talk of something/someone — 談到；提起****

****talk of**** is similar to ****talk about****, but it can sound slightly more literary or formal in some contexts.

Practice 1

> They often ****talk of the years they spent abroad****.

他們經常**談起那些在外國生活的歲月**。

Practice 2

> Everyone was ****talking of her remarkable performance****.

大家都在**談論她出色的表現**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk of = 提到或談論某人 / 某事****

Important distinction

* ****talk about the problem**** → 很普通、最常用

* ****talk of the problem**** → 也可解作談及，但有時語氣較正式或書面

For learners, ****talk about**** is usually the safer default.

4. ****talk to someone about something — 跟某人談某件事****

This combines the ****person**** and the ****topic****.

Practice 1

> You should ****talk to your teacher about the problem****.

你應該**跟老師談談這個問題**。

Practice 2

> I need to **talk** to my manager about my schedule.

我需要**跟經理談談我的工作時間安排**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk to someone about something = 就某件事與某人交談或商討

5. **talk = discuss something seriously — 商談；商討**

Sometimes **talk** refers not merely to casual conversation but to **serious discussion intended to deal with a situation**.

Practice 1

> We need to **talk** about what happened yesterday.

我們需要**認真談談**昨天發生的事。

Practice 2

> The two sides agreed to **talk** before making a final decision.

雙方同意在作出最終決定前先進行**商談**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk = 就重要問題進行較認真的討論或商談

6. **talk business / politics / money etc. — 談生意 / 政治 / 金錢等**

With some topic nouns, **talk + noun** means **discuss that particular subject**.

Practice 1

> Let's have lunch and **talk business**.

我們一起吃午飯，順便**談談生意**吧。

Practice 2

> My parents try not to **talk politics** at family dinners.

我父母盡量不在家庭聚餐時**談政治**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk + topic noun = 談論某一特定範疇的事情****

7. ****talk = speak rather than remain silent — 說話；開口****

Here, ****talk**** focuses simply on the act of ****speaking****.

Practice 1

> The baby is beginning to ****talk****.

那個嬰兒開始會****說話****了。

Practice 2

> He was so nervous that he could hardly ****talk****.

他緊張得幾乎****說不出話來****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk = 用口語說話；發出有意義的語言****

8. ****talk = be able to use spoken language — 會說話****

This is especially common when discussing a young child's language development.

Practice 1

> Most children learn to ****talk**** long before they learn to read.

大多數小孩在學會閱讀之前很久就已經學會****說話****。

Practice 2

> She could already ****talk**** quite clearly at the age of two.

她兩歲時已經可以很清楚地****說話****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk = 具備使用口語表達自己的能力****

9. ****talk = speak in a particular way — 以某種方式說話****

Often used with adverbs or descriptions.

Practice 1

> He ****talks very quietly**** when he is nervous.

他緊張時****說話很小聲****。

Practice 2

> Don't ****talk so fast****; I can't follow you.

不要****說得那麼快****，我跟不上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk = 以某種速度、音量、語氣等方式說話****

10. ****talk = say things, especially too much or without action — 說個不停；只是嘴上說****

In some contexts, ****talk**** contrasts with ****action****.

Practice 1

> He is always ****talking****, but he never actually does anything.

他總是****說個不停****，但實際上甚麼也不做。

Practice 2

> We need action, not just ****talk****.

我們需要的是行動，而不只是****空談****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk = 言談、說法；有時帶有「只有說、沒有行動」的意思****

11. **talk someone into something / doing something — 說服某人做某事**

This is a very common phrasal extension.

Practice 1

> She **talked me into applying for the job**.

她**說服我申請那份工作**。

Practice 2

> He somehow **talked his parents into buying him a bicycle**.

他不知怎樣**說服父母買了一輛單車給他**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk someone into doing something = 透過交談或勸說，使某人同意做某事

12. **talk someone out of something / doing something — 勸某人不要做某事**

The opposite direction of **talk someone into**.

Practice 1

> I tried to **talk him out of quitting his job**.

我試圖**勸他不要辭職**。

Practice 2

> Her friends **talked her out of making a rushed decision**.

她的朋友**勸她不要倉促作決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk someone out of doing something = 透過勸說，使某人放棄做某事

13. **talk someone through something — 逐步向某人解釋 / 指導**

The speaker explains a process carefully, usually step by step.

Practice 1

> The technician **talked me through the installation process**.

技術人員**逐步向我解釋安裝程序**。

Practice 2

> She **talked him through what to do in an emergency**.

她**一步一步告訴他遇到緊急情況時該怎樣做**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk someone through something = 用說話逐步解釋某個程序或做法

14. **talk over something** — 商量；詳細討論

A common phrasal extension meaning to discuss something before deciding.

Practice 1

> We should **talk it over** before making a decision.

我們作決定之前應該先**好好商量一下**。

Practice 2

> She **talked the problem over with her parents**.

她跟父母**仔細商量了這個問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk something over = 仔細討論某件事，通常為了作出決定

15. **talk back** — 頂嘴

Especially when a child or subordinate answers someone in a disrespectful way.

Practice 1

> Don't **talk back** to your mother.

不要跟你媽媽**頂嘴**。

Practice 2

> The teacher was annoyed because the student kept **talking back**.

那位老師很生氣，因為那名學生一直**頂嘴**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk back = 以不尊重或反駁的態度回答權威人物

16. **talk down to someone — 用居高臨下的語氣跟某人說話**

Practice 1

> I dislike people who **talk down to younger colleagues**.

我不喜歡那些**用居高臨下的語氣跟年輕同事說話**的人。

Practice 2

> Please don't **talk down to me** as if I were a child.

請不要好像把我當小孩一樣**用高高在上的語氣跟我說話**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk down to someone = 用令人感到被看低、不受尊重的語氣對某人說話

17. **talk up someone/something — 大力稱讚；宣傳；吹捧**

Practice 1

> The company has been **talking up its new product**.

那家公司一直在**大力宣傳其新產品**。

Practice 2

> Everyone **talked her up** before the interview.

面試前，大家都**大力稱讚她的能力**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk someone/something up = 積極稱讚或宣傳，使其看起來更好、更重要****

18. ****talk = reveal information / confess, especially under pressure — 開口供出資料****

This is common in crime, police, and informal contexts.

Practice 1

> The police hoped the suspect would eventually ****talk****.

警方希望疑犯最後會****開口供出資料****。

Practice 2

> He refused to ****talk****, even after hours of questioning.

即使被盤問了幾個小時，他仍拒絕****開口透露消息****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talk = 向他人透露原本不願提供的資料，尤其在盤問或壓力下****

19. ****talk = gossip / spread information — 說閒話；議論****

Practice 1

> If they see us together, people will ****talk****.

如果他們看見我們在一起，人們一定會****說閒話****。

Practice 2

> The sudden resignation really got the whole office ****talking****.

那次突然辭職令整個辦公室的人都開始****議論紛紛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****people talk = 人們議論、說閒話或傳播相關消息****

20. ****talk = communicate or negotiate — 進行談判****

This is particularly common in diplomacy, labour disputes, politics, and business.

Practice 1

> The two governments have agreed to **talk**.

兩國政府已同意進行**談判**。

Practice 2

> Management and the union are finally **talking again**.

管理層和工會終於再次展開**談判**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk = 為解決分歧或達成協議而進行談判

21. **talks** (plural noun) — 會談；談判

The plural noun **talks** very often refers to formal negotiations.

Practice 1

> Peace **talks** resumed on Monday.

和平**談判**於星期一恢復。

Practice 2

> The two companies are holding **talks** about a possible merger.

兩家公司正在就可能的合併進行**商談**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talks = 雙方或多方為達成協議而進行的正式會談或談判

Important distinction

a talk and **talks** can mean very different things:

* **a talk** → 一場演講 / 講座

* **talks** → 會談 / 談判

22. **a talk — 談話；一次交談**

A countable noun referring to one particular conversation.

Practice 1

> We had a long **talk** about his future.

我們就他的未來**談了很久**。

Practice 2

> I think you and I need to have a **talk**.

我想你和我需要**好好談一談**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a talk = 一次較完整或較認真的交談

23. **a talk — 演講；講座**

A speaker presents information to an audience.

Practice 1

> She gave a **talk** on climate change.

她作了一場有關氣候變化的**演講**。

Practice 2

> I attended an interesting **talk** about artificial intelligence.

我參加了一場很有趣的人工智能**講座**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a talk = 向一群聽眾講解某個主題的演講或講座

24. **talk (uncountable noun) — 談話；討論**

Practice 1

> There has been a lot of **talk** about changing the law.

最近有很多關於修改法例的**討論**。

Practice 2

> All this **talk** of moving abroad is making me nervous.

這些關於移居外國的**談論**令我有點不安。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk = 關於某事的談論或討論

25. **talk** = rumours / speculation — 傳聞；議論

The noun can refer to things people are saying when the facts are not necessarily confirmed.

Practice 1

> There is **talk** of another round of job cuts.

有**傳聞 / 消息**指可能會有另一輪裁員。

Practice 2

> The announcement ended months of **talk** about a possible takeover.

這項公布結束了持續數月、有關可能收購的**傳聞和議論**。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk = 人們廣泛流傳但未必已證實的說法或議論

26. **small talk** — 閒聊；寒暄

Small talk means light conversation about ordinary, non-serious subjects.

Practice 1

> I'm terrible at making **small talk** with strangers.

我很不擅長跟陌生人**寒暄閒聊**。

Practice 2

> They made **small talk** while waiting for the meeting to begin.

他們等候會議開始時隨意**閒聊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

small talk = 關於日常、輕鬆、不太重要話題的社交性閒聊

27. **pep talk — 鼓勵性的談話**

Usually given to motivate someone before a difficult task or competition.

Practice 1

> The coach gave the players a **pep talk** before the match.

教練在比賽前對球員作了一番**鼓舞士氣的談話**。

Practice 2

> I needed a quick **pep talk** before my presentation.

簡報之前，我需要有人跟我說幾句**鼓勵的話**。

MCQ-ready definition:

pep talk = 為鼓勵、激勵某人而進行的談話

28. **sales talk — 推銷說辭**

Practice 1

> Ignore the **sales talk** and check the actual specifications.

不要只聽那些**推銷說辭**，要看看實際規格。

Practice 2

> His presentation sounded more like **sales talk** than objective advice.

他的簡報聽起來更像**推銷說辭**，而不是客觀建議。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sales talk = 為說服別人購買產品或接受某想法而說的一套推銷話語****

29. ****straight talk — 坦率直接的說話****

Practice 1

> What we need now is some ****straight talk**** about the problem.

我們現在需要的是對這個問題作一些****坦率直接的討論****。

Practice 2

> She is known for her ****straight talk**** and practical advice.

她以****說話坦率直接****和提供實際建議而聞名。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****straight talk = 坦白、直接、不拐彎抹角的說話方式****

30. ****double-talk — 含糊矛盾、故意令人混淆的說法****

Practice 1

> His answer was full of political ****double-talk****.

他的回答充滿****含糊而令人混淆的說辭****。

Practice 2

> Customers are tired of corporate ****double-talk****.

顧客已厭倦企業那些****避重就輕、含糊不清的說法****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****double-talk = 故意使用含糊、矛盾或令人困惑的語言來逃避清楚回答****

31. ****talking point — 討論焦點；談論重點****

Practice 1

> The new design became a major **“talking point”** at the conference.

這個新設計成為會議上的主要**“討論焦點”**。

Practice 2

> His unusual jacket was quite a **“talking point”**.

他那件特別的外套成了大家的**“話題”**。

“MCQ-ready definition:”

“talking point = 很值得討論、容易引起談話的事情或議題”

32. **“talk show — 清談節目；訪談節目”**

Practice 1

> She appeared on a popular television **“talk show”**.

她亮相了一個很受歡迎的電視**“清談節目”**。

Practice 2

> The actor discussed his new film on a late-night **“talk show”**.

那位演員在一個深夜**“訪談節目”**中談及自己的新電影。

“MCQ-ready definition:”

“talk show = 以主持人與嘉賓交談、訪問為主要內容的電視或電台節目”

33. **“talk radio — 以談話 / 討論為主的電台節目形式”**

Practice 1

> He listens to **“talk radio”** during his drive to work.

他開車上班時會收聽**“以討論和談話為主的電台節目”**。

Practice 2

> The issue was widely discussed on **talk radio**.

這個議題在各個**談話型電台節目**中被廣泛討論。

MCQ-ready definition:

talk radio = 以訪談、聽眾來電或議題討論為主要內容的廣播節目

34. **a talking-to** — 訓話；責備

Informal.

Practice 1

> His father gave him a serious **talking-to**.

他爸爸把他**嚴厲訓了一頓**。

Practice 2

> She got a **talking-to** from her manager for arriving late again.

她因再次遲到而被經理**責備了一頓**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a talking-to = 因某人做錯事而對其作出的嚴肅責備或訓話

35. **talkative** — 健談的；多話的

This describes a person who talks a lot.

Practice 1

> Leo is especially **talkative** when he gets excited.

Leo 一興奮起來就特別**健談 / 多話**。

Practice 2

> She is quiet at first but becomes very **talkative** once she feels comfortable.

她起初比較安靜，但感到自在之後就會變得很**健談**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talkative = 喜歡說很多話的；很健談的****

36. ****talker — 健談的人；以某種方式說話的人****

Practice 1

> He's a great ****talker****, but not such a good listener.

他很****健談****，但就不太擅長聆聽。

Practice 2

> She is a fast ****talker****, so I sometimes struggle to follow her.

她是個****說話很快的人****，所以我有時很難跟得上。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****talker = 說話很多或具有某種說話特點的人****

Important distinction 1: ****talk vs speak****

They overlap, but they are not identical.

****talk****

Often emphasizes ****conversation or interaction****.

> I was ****talking to Leo****.

我當時正在****跟 Leo 聊天 / 交談****。

****speak****

Can emphasize the ****act or ability of speaking****, and is also common in formal situations.

> She ****speaks English**** fluently.

她能流利地****說英語****。

> The manager would like to ****speak to you****.

經理想**跟你談一下**。

A useful learner rule:

- * **talk to someone** → very natural for ordinary conversation
- * **speak to someone** → can be ordinary too, but often slightly more formal
- * **speak a language** → normal
- * **talk a language** → normally incorrect

Important distinction 2: **talk vs say**

say focuses on **the words/content produced**.

> He **said**, "I'm tired."

他**說**：「我累了。」

talk focuses more on **the activity of conversation**.

> We **talked** for two hours.

我們**聊了兩個小時**。

So:

- * **say something**
- * **talk to someone**
- * **talk about something**

Important distinction 3: **talk vs tell**

tell normally takes a person or conveys information.

> She **told me** the truth.

她**告訴我**真相。

But:

> She **talked to me** about the problem.

她**跟我談了**這個問題。

Not:

>  She talked me the truth.

Important distinction 4: **talk to vs talk with**

Both can mean **與某人交談**.

> I **talked to Leo**.

> I **talked with Leo**.

In ordinary modern English, **talk to** is extremely common and does **not necessarily** mean one person is doing all the talking.

talk with can place slightly more emphasis on a two-way exchange, especially in American English, but the difference is usually small.

Important distinction 5: **talk to someone vs talk at someone**

talk to someone

normal interaction

> She **talked to me** about school.

她跟我談學校的事。

talk at someone

one person talks continuously without really allowing interaction

> He didn't have a conversation with us; he just **talked at us** for an hour.

他根本不是跟我們交談，只是對着我們**單方面講了一個小時**。

Important distinction 6: **talk about vs discuss**

Both can mean **討論**.

> We **talked about** the problem.

> We **discussed** the problem.

But grammar differs:

*  **talk about the problem**

*  **discuss the problem**

*  **discuss about the problem**

discuss also often sounds somewhat more formal or structured.

Important distinction 7: **a talk vs a conversation**

a conversation

Usually implies a genuine exchange between people.

a talk

Can mean:

1. a conversation, often fairly serious
2. a presentation or lecture

So:

> We had **a talk** about his behaviour.

我們就他的行為**談了一次**。

but:

> She gave **a talk** about astronomy.

她作了一場天文學**講座**。

Important distinction 8: **talk vs chat**

chat generally means relaxed, friendly, informal conversation.

> We **chatted** over coffee.

我們一邊喝咖啡一邊**閒聊**。

talk is much broader. It can be casual, serious, formal, argumentative, instructional, or diplomatic.

Important distinction 9: **talk vs speech**

A **talk** is often relatively informal and may be conversational.

A **speech** is typically more formal and delivered to an audience.

> She gave a short **talk** about her research.

她作了一個較輕鬆的研究**分享 / 講座**。

> The president delivered a formal **speech**.

總統發表了一篇正式**演說**。

Important distinction 10: **talk into vs talk out of**

They point in opposite directions:

* **talk someone into doing X**

→ **說服某人去做 X**

* **talk someone out of doing X**

→ **說服某人不要做 X**

> She **talked me into going**.

她說服我去。

> She **talked me out of going**.

她勸我不要去做。

Family-extension note

talk is a particularly strong polysemy candidate because its core idea of **spoken communication** extends into several genuinely useful areas:

- * ordinary conversation
- * discussing a topic
- * serious discussion
- * negotiation
- * disclosure of information
- * gossip
- * a lecture or presentation
- * rumours or public discussion

It also has many highly useful constructions such as **talk someone into**, **talk someone out of**, and **talk something over**.

However, compounds such as **small talk**, **talk show**, **pep talk**, and **talking point** should be treated as **useful lexical extensions**, not as additional meanings of the bare verb **talk** itself. That distinction keeps the family broad without artificially inflating the meaning count.

Master comparison

Form / pattern	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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talk to/with someone	跟某人交談	spoken interaction	
talk about something	談論某事	discuss a topic	
talk of something	談及；提起	mention/discuss	
talk to someone about X	跟某人談 X	person + topic	
we need to talk	我們需要談談	serious discussion	
talk business/politics	談生意 / 政治	discuss a field	
learn to talk	學會說話	acquire speech	
talk fast/quietly	說得快 / 小聲	manner of speaking	
all talk, no action	只會說、不行動	words rather than action	
talk someone into X	說服某人做 X	persuade to do	
talk someone out of X	勸某人不要做 X	persuade not to do	
talk someone through X	逐步向某人解釋 X	guide verbally	
talk something over	商量；仔細討論	discuss before deciding	
talk back	頂嘴	disrespectful reply	
talk down to someone	居高臨下地說話	condescending speech	
talk up X	大力宣傳 / 稱讚	promote verbally	
the suspect talked	疑犯開口供出資料	reveal information	
people will talk	人們會說閒話	gossip	
the governments are talking	政府正在談判	negotiate	

peace talks	和平談判	formal negotiations	
have a talk	談一談	a conversation	
give a talk	作演講 / 講座	presentation	
a lot of talk about X	大量有關 X 的討論	public discussion	
talk of job cuts	裁員傳聞	rumours/speculation	
small talk	閒聊；寒暄	light social conversation	
pep talk	鼓勵性的談話	motivational speech	
sales talk	推銷說辭	persuasive selling language	
straight talk	坦率直言	direct speech	
double-talk	含糊混淆的說辭	evasive/confusing language	
talking point	討論焦點；話題	discussion-worthy issue	
talk show	清談 / 訪談節目	interview-based programme	
talk radio	談話型電台節目	discussion radio	
a talking-to	訓話；責備	reprimand	
talkative	健談的；多話的	inclined to talk	
talker	健談的人 / 某種說話者	person characterized by speech	

For your original sentence

> Sometimes ****talking to him**** is like trying to keep up with a tiny scientist, because his mind moves at lightning speed.

Here:

****talking to him = 跟他交談 / 跟他聊天****

The focus is ****interactive conversation with Leo****.

The sentence suggests that when the speaker has a conversation with Leo, ****Leo produces ideas and questions so quickly that the speaker has to work hard mentally to keep up****.

So this is the ordinary interpersonal meaning:

****talk to someone → 與某人交談、溝通****

—not ****give a talk****, ****negotiate****, ****gossip****, or merely ****speak aloud****.